

1. Subject-Verb Concord Rules

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The Basic Principle

A singular subject takes a singular verb, whereas a plural subject takes a plural verb.

Example: The student reads books daily. / The students read books daily.

Proximity Rule & Parenthetical Expressions

Words introduced by phrases like 'as well as', 'together with', 'in addition to', 'accompanied by' do not affect the grammatical subject.

Example: The teacher, together with her students, IS attending the conference.

2. Correlative Conjunctions & Indefinite Pronouns

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Either/Neither Agreement

With 'Either...or' and 'Neither...nor', the verb agrees with the closer subject.

Example: Neither the principal nor the teachers were present.

Neither the teachers nor the principal was present.

Indefinite Pronouns

'Each', 'Everyone', 'Somebody', 'Nobody', 'Either' universally take singular verbs in formal English.

Example: Each of the candidates is qualified.